

Alilat (cf. iii. 8. 3) = Al Ilât, 'the goddess.' What was originally a common noun became a proper name; so 'Astarte', properly an epithet signifying fruitfulness (Deut. vii. 13), became the name of a goddess.

- 132 I θυσίη. For the resemblances of the 'manner of sacrifice to the rites of the Ali Allahis in modern Persia' cf. Rawlinson, *ad loc.*; the open air sacrifice, the 'myrtle', the 'hymn' (ἐπαιδὴν), the 'boiling of the flesh', and its distribution to the worshippers all occur in the modern rite. There can be no doubt that H. had watched a Persian sacrifice. Strabo (733) gives a fuller description, based partly on H., and partly on what he had seen in Armenia.

H.'s object throughout is to contrast Persian and Greek customs; this will explain his verbal inaccuracies. The victim is not burned as in Greece, but H. writes loosely (cf. 131. 1 n.) in saying 'no fire is kindled'; there was fire in the Persian sacrifices, but it was fed with wood; there were no 'libations' of wine; but the sacred water ('zasthra', S. B. E. iv, p. 69) was sometimes poured (cf. vii. 54. 2 (Xerxes at the Hellespont), 188. 2 n.); the fillet (ἐστεφανωμένος) was not a Greek στέμμα, which was always intertwined with woollen threads.

οὐλῆσι. For the sacred 'barley' and its πρόχυσις cf. 160. 5, and Gardner and Jevons, G. A. p. 250. The meal offering of barley went with the burnt offering, as bread goes with meats in a meal (cf. Lev. ix. 17 R.V.). Another contrast is that the Greeks sacrificed bare-headed but for a garland, the Persian wore his 'tiara'.

καθάρων. The idea is double, partly a place free from pollution, partly one where there is no obstacle to sacrifice; cf. vii. 183. 2 τὸ ἐμποδῶν ἐγεγόνεε καθάρων.

- 2 ἀπαλός, 'fresh'; cf. ii. 92. 4 ἀπαλὰ καὶ αὖσα. ὦν marks the apodosis.

- 3 For the Magians cf. 101 n. and App. VIII, § 3.

οἷην δῆ. Translate 'for such they say the invocation is'; H. does not profess himself to have understood the incantation. Darmstetter (iv. 53) says, 'H. may have heard the Magi sing the very same Gathas which are now sung by the Mobeds in Bombay.' The hymns invoke Ormazd and his ministering spirits and dwell upon their attributes; they are not a 'Theogony' in the Hesiodic sense (ii. 53. 2 n.).

ὁ θύσας. Greek usage left a portion for the priests. Strabo (732) says the Persian god's share was the life (ψυχῇ) of the victim.

λόγος αἰρείει. More often without an object (cf. vi. 124. 3); 'as reason takes him,' i.e. as he pleases.

- 133 I ὅλους κτλ. Aristophanes (Ach. 85-7) parodies this passage; cf. 3. 2 n.

Cf. ix. 110. 2 for the royal birthday.

τὰ λεπτὰ; i.e. sheep and goats; πρόβατον includes, especially in Ionic Greek, all beasts of the herd that 'go before' the shepherd.

- 2 The Greeks, like the moderns, had their 'dessert dishes' (ἐπι-

φορήματα) served up after the solid food (σίτα, cf. ἀπὸ δείπνου); the Persians had them, not 'as one course' (ἀλέσει), but at intervals during the meal. H. Rawlinson (*ad loc.*) compares the fondness of the modern Persians for sweetmeats (but these are now served before the meal).

3 Anything that left the body became separated from life and so unclean. For the strange rules of the Avesta on these subjects cf. Fargard, xvii, as to paring the nails; ib. xviii. 40-9, as to the urine (iv. 185, 197).

4 The first part of this custom is ascribed by Tacitus (Germ. 22) to the Germans; he gives the reason 'Deliberant dum fingere nesciunt, constituunt dum errare non possunt' (cf. Mrs. Nickleby, 'Wine in, truth out'). Lack of humour in historians has erected into a system what was merely due to excess.

For Persian drinking cf. Curzon, ii. 506, (The Persian) 'is not a tippler but a toper, not a drinker, but a drunkard', quoting other authorities for the same view.

4 1 H. Rawlinson compares the devotion to etiquette among the modern Persians, 'the Frenchmen of the East'; the salute, however, now is never on the lips.

The prostration of an inferior is familiar in the East (iii. 86. 21; it was as repulsive to the Greeks as the Chinese 'kotow' to Doyle's 'Private of the Buffs'. Cf. vii. 136. 1, and the refusal of Callisthenes to prostrate himself before Alexander (Arr. Anab. iv. 10. 5 seq.).

2 ἀρίστους. The Persian Shah, till he was deposed, was called 'the centre of the Universe'. H., however, makes too systematic the conceit common to all nations, civilized as well as uncivilized.

Two points must be distinguished:

(1) The Persian system of graduated respect.

(2) The Median system of graduated rule, which H. compares to it (§ 3 *ad fin.* 'in the same way as the Persian show degrees of honour').

As to (2) H. is again too systematic, but he represents accurately the broad facts of the contrast between Persian and Median rule; under the Medes, the subject kingdoms paid tribute or sent gifts, while they still ruled their own dependents; under Persia, all districts alike were under the satraps, and in direct relation to the great king (iii. 87 seq.).

3 The sentence is carefully balanced; καὶ τῶν ὁμοῦρων answers to μάλα (= μαλ' αὐτῆς, 'in their turn') τῶν ἐχομένων.

προΐβαινε γὰρ κτλ. is variously explained:

(1) Rawlinson refers τὸ ἔθνος to the Persians; but this is incorrect in fact and spoils the antithesis.

(2) Stein takes it of the Medes; translate 'The race went forward thus ever from government by themselves (ἄρχον) to government through others' (ἐπιτροπεῦον); but it is hard to get this sense out of ἐπιτροπεῦον, which = 'administering' (iii. 36. 3) or 'being regent

for' (655); the above sense would require ἐπιτρέπον, i. e. 'deputing' (τὴν ἀρχήν), and the ellipse would be harsh.

(3) It is simplest therefore to make τὸ ἔθνος distributive, 'each nation took its place in order as ruler and administrator.' This sentence then simply repeats generally what H. has already said more definitely above; it may be a gloss, and Krüger brackets it.

135 Hellenicus (fr. 169; F. H. G. i. 68) says the Persians learned the practice of castration from the Babylonians; cf. H. iii. 92. 1.

ἰσθῆτα. H. describes the 'Median' armament (σκευή) of the Persian 'Immortals' in vii. 61 (v. n.); the real Persian dress was of leather (σκυτίνη), and its main feature the trousers (71. 2); such a dress, fitting closely, is worn by the common soldiers on the monuments, while the king and his attendants have a long flowing dress. (Rawlinson, *ad loc.*, gives pictures.) Cf. Strabo, 525, for the borrowing. Curzon, ii. 633, speaks of '(Persian) imitativeness long notorious in the East'. He also agrees with c. 134 as to Persian conceit (p. 628).

παισί: the vice was older and is denounced in the Vendidad (Farg. 8. 5; iv. 102); Greek influence may have helped to spread it.

136 I πολλοὺς παῖδας. Cf. Vend. Farg. 4. 47; iv. 46, 'He who has children is far above the childless man.' Large families were both commended for religious motives (Ormazd is the Lord of Life), and politically were all-important to a small ruling caste.

2 ἱππεύειν. Xenophon (Cyr. i. 3. 3) says that Cyrus made the Persians a nation of horsemen; this is thought by some (e.g. Meyer, iii. 9) to be a pure invention; it is argued that Xenophon, as a cavalry officer, wished his countrymen to develop that arm of their forces; hence Cyrus' supposed development is merely an object-lesson to the Greeks. But as the Persians were largely a race of mountaineers, cavalry can hardly have played much part among them till Cyrus began a career of conquest. Hence Xenophon may be right on this point.

ἀληθίζεσθαι. The importance of 'Truth' is brought out in the B. J. i. 10, 'The lie became abounding in the land'; iv. 13, (Ormazd helps Darius) 'because I was not wicked nor was I a liar' (cf. also col. iv. 4, 5, 6, 8). The liar is a 'Mithra-drug'; he offends against the all-seeing sun-god, who is the guardian of contracts (cf. 138. 1). For a transgression of the rule as to Truth cf. iii. 72 n. H. is right in crediting the Persians with the virtues of chivalry.

137 μηδένα is both subject and object; this double use of a word is frequent in H. (e.g. viii. 142. 3).

For compensation in mitigation of punishment cf. Sandoces, vii. 194. 2. The principle was extended to religion; in modern Parseeism every offence and every good deed has a price, and so a balance is struck (S. B. E. iv. 99 n.).

138 Aristotle (Hist. Anim. iii. 11, p. 518) describes the λεύκη, which seems to have been a mild form of leprosy. Leper isolation was

general in the East; cf. Lev. xiii. 46 for the Jews, who (like the Persians) looked upon the disease as the symbol and the result of moral evil. The Vendidad is a Persian Leviticus, and is mainly comprised of laws of purification (cf. Farg. 5. 21; iv. 55); 'Purity is for man, next to life, the greatest good.' Savage analogies are numerous; cf. Tylor, *Prim. Cult.* ii⁴. 429 for 'Lustration'.

- 2 Charon (fr. 3, F. H. G. i. 32) spoke of 'white doves' in connexion with Mardonius' expedition in 493 B.C. (described in vi. 44-5) (cf. *Introd.* § 19); perhaps these doves belonged to the Phoenician sailors. H. here seems to connect them with leprosy.

ἐς ποταμόν. The prohibition is due to respect to the element, water (cf. c. 140 for respect to the earth, and vii. 113. 2 for worship of rivers). So in later developments of the religion, the Magi are said to have deposed a king for building bath-houses; bathing smacked of heresy (S. B. E. iv. 90 n.).

- I H. is at his weakest as a linguist (cf. explanation of royal names, vi. 98. 3 n.); yet he seems to have valued himself on this score. He makes two remarks on Persian names, which are both inaccurate:

(1) That they all have a certain meaning. *σῶμα* is variously taken (a) by Stein, in a general sense, 'individuals (32. 8) and their honourable nature'; (b) by Macaulay, 'their bodily shape' (which is simpler). Whichever sense be given, H. is too absolute; nor is he consistent; cf. vi. 98. Some Persian names referred to deities (cf. Mithradates, 'given by Mithra'); others to personal appearance (Otanēs, 'fair of body'); others (e.g. Darius, 'possessor') to position, &c.

(2) That all names end in S. This, in the first place, ignores all feminine names. Even of men's names, it is only true of the Greek forms; in Persian, *s* (sh) was retained after *i* or *u*, e.g. Darayavaush = Darius, but not otherwise, e.g. Vistâḥa (Hystaspēs), where, however, the final *a* was not written.

For the interesting statement as to the Greek alphabet cf. Roberts, *Gk. Epig.* p. 8 seq. The Phoenicians had four signs for sibilants, each of which was borrowed in part by Greece:

(1) The hard Samech (No. 15 in the Phoenician alphabet; sign **Ξ**), probably = 'Sigma'. Others, however, make 'σίγμα' ('the hissing letter') a genuine Greek word (from σίζω).

(2) The lingual Tsade (No. 18; sign **Ϡ**).

(3) The palatal Shin (No. 21; sign **Ϻ**).

(4) There was also the soft Zazin (No. 7; sign **Ι**).

Of these the name Tsade survives in Zeta, while 'Samech' was transferred to the place of 'Shin'. The sign of Samech and its place in the alphabet after '**Λ**', were left to the later Xi.

For 'San' cf. Pind. fr. 79. H. probably means by 'San' the **Μ** of the old Dorian inscriptions, while his 'Sigma' is the **Σ** **ξ** of the older Ionic ones.

- 0 I The dead body had passed under the control of the evil spirit